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Survey plan and script

Astral customer discovery
Draft for review · October 2026

Survey plan and script



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The plan

Draft questions. Answer options come from scoping, existing interview notes, and desk research, in customers' own words. Grey options are placeholders to fill before the pilot.

SURVEY · STAGES 4, 5 AND 7

Survey plan

Gauge how often the activities, checks, and problems we ask about happen across a wider group of respondents. It runs alongside the interviews.

PROVISIONAL DURATION

Built in week 1, then open for 8 working days from the start of week 2

DEPENDS ON

Agreed scope. An approved survey tool. Distribution route. Reachable population known

OBJECTIVES IT SERVES

- 3. Understand what people check before they trust and share a figure or a report.
- 6. Gauge how often the activities, checks, and problems we ask about happen across a wider group of respondents.

Other questions give reported frequency for patterns found under objectives 1, 2, 4, and 5.

OUTPUT

Reported patterns across respondents, with sampling limits stated. Analysed with the interviews.

How it is built

The survey opens alongside the interviews, so it cannot be built from them. It is built from what we already know, then piloted.

1

Build from what we know

Answer options come from scoping, Clive and Emily's interview notes, and desk research, in customers' words.

2

Ask about behaviour

Ask about behaviour, not about which persona someone is.

3

Pilot, then send

Pilot with target users to check meaning, answer options, routing, and effort.

4

Analyse with the interviews

The survey shows how often. The interviews show why. Results describe respondents.

Ask this	Not this
In the past three months, how often have you compared figures from more than one source before sharing a report?	Are you an evidence-led analyst?

Rules

- A recall period that fits each activity. Monthly reporting and annual processes need different treatment
- Include “not applicable” and “don't know”. Keep them apart from missing answers
- Wording, options, and order change results
- Set the response target only after we know the reachable population, sampling approach, and comparisons needed
- Results describe **respondents** unless the sampling supports wider claims
- Report people and customer organisations separately
- More responses do not remove recruitment bias

Watch out. A survey written from our assumptions may

- miss activities customers think are important
- use words that do not match how people describe their work
- force people into categories that do not fit
- collect feature wishes instead of explaining needs

The pilot, the open “Other” options, and the interviews help catch this.

Preparing and sending

Stages 4 and 5 run in week 1, alongside interview recruitment. Stage 7 needs little moderating: open it, check in, and send one reminder.

STAGE 4 · PREPARE

- Build the questions and routing in SurveyMonkey or Microsoft Forms
- Test every route in the routes table
- Pilot with 2 or 3 target users on day 4. Set the time on the introduction screen
- Write the invitation email and one reminder
- Privacy owner signs off the tool, the consent wording, and where answers are stored

STAGE 5 · RECRUIT

- Agree who receives it: the reachable population
- Agree who sends it, such as the access coordinator or account managers
- Get the distribution list ready
- Set the response target

STAGE 7 · RUN

- Send the invitation on the first day of week 2
- Leave it open. It needs no moderating
- Check responses every couple of days
- Send one reminder after 4 working days
- Close in the middle of week 3

CHECK THE TOOL FIRST

Check the tool handles the routing before building. B1 and D1 reuse earlier answers. If the tool cannot, B1 becomes one grid question listing every activity, and D1 asks about the activity that takes most time.

Flow and logic

Everyone answers A and F. B to E show only to people who do the work they ask about. “Don't know” and “Not applicable” are always offered and coded apart from missing answers.

START

Introduction and consent

Everyone

Q0

SECTION A

Your work with IMSERV data

Everyone who agreed

A1, A2

SECTION B

How often

If A2 has an activity

B1, B2

SECTION C

Checking before you rely on a figure

If A2 includes investigating, reconciling, or reporting

C1, C2, C3

SECTION D

Where the work goes

If A2 has an activity

D1, D2, D3, D4

SECTION E

When things go wrong

If A2 has an activity

E1, E2, E3, E4

SECTION F

About you and your organisation

Everyone who agreed

F1, F2, F3, F4, F5

END

Thank you

Thank you. Your answers help us design Astral around how people really work.

At	When	Go to
Q0	No	End
A1	Only “I don't use IMSERV data”	Section F
A2	“None of these” or “Don't know”	Section F
B1	Each activity chosen in A2	Repeat B1
B2	Fewer than two activities in A2	Skip B2
C	A2 has no investigating, reconciling, or reporting	Skip to D
D3	“No one” or “Don't know”	Skip D4
E1	No or Don't know	Section F
F5	Yes	Contact details, then end

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The questions

INTRODUCTION SCREEN

"We're the UX team at IMSERV. We want to understand how people work with IMSERV energy data, so we can improve Astral. It takes about [time, set after the pilot]. Taking part is voluntary, and you can skip any question. [Approved privacy and consent wording.]"

START · EVERYONE

Introduction and consent

Q0 Do you agree to take part?

SINGLE CHOICE

- ○ Yes
- ○ No

Logic. No → end. Nothing is stored.

SECTION A · EVERYONE WHO AGREED

Your work with IMSERV data

A1 How do you get IMSERV data today? OBJ 1 OBJ 6

SELECT ALL THAT APPLY

- ☐ I log in to the IMSERV portal myself
- ☐ Someone else sends me files or reports
- ☐ It comes through an API or another system
- ☐ I don't use IMSERV data
- ☐ Don't know

Logic. "I don't use IMSERV data" and "Don't know" are exclusive. "I don't use IMSERV data" → Section F.

A2 In the past three months, which of these have you done with IMSERV data? OBJ 2 OBJ 6

SELECT ALL THAT APPLY

- ☐ Investigated data that did not look right
- ☐ Reconciled figures from different sources
- ☐ Prepared or shared a report
- ☐ Managed who can see data, sites, or documents
- ☐ Raised or followed up a service issue with IMSERV
- ☐ [Other activities named in scoping or existing notes]
- ☐ None of these
- ☐ Don't know

Logic. "None of these" and "Don't know" are exclusive → Section F. Choices carry into B1, B2, and C.

SECTION B · IF A2 HAS AN ACTIVITY

How often

B1 In the past three months, about how often did you *[activity from A2]*? OBJ 6

SINGLE CHOICE, ONCE PER ACTIVITY CHOSEN IN A2

- ○ More than once a week
- ○ About once a week
- ○ About once a month
- ○ Once or twice
- ○ Don't know

Logic. Repeats for each activity. Check the recall period in the pilot. Annual processes need different treatment.

B2 Which of these takes most of your time? OBJ 2

SINGLE CHOICE

- ○ [Activities chosen in A2]
- ○ Don't know

Logic. Shown only if A2 has two or more activities. Otherwise the one activity carries into D1.

SECTION C · IF A2 INCLUDES INVESTIGATING, RECONCILING, OR REPORTING

Checking before you rely on a figure

C1 In the past three months, how often have you compared figures from more than one source before sharing a report? OBJ 3 OBJ 6

SINGLE CHOICE

- ○ Every time
- ○ Most times
- ○ Sometimes
- ○ Never
- ○ Not applicable, I don't share reports
- ○ Don't know

Logic. Not applicable and Don't know are coded apart from missing answers.

C2 Before you rely on a figure from IMSERV, what do you usually check? OBJ 3 OBJ 6

SELECT ALL THAT APPLY

- ☐ [Checks named in existing notes, in customers' words]
- ☐ Something else (please say)
- ☐ I don't usually check
- ☐ Don't know

Logic. "I don't usually check" and "Don't know" are exclusive. "Something else" → short text.

C3 By the time you share a figure, how confident are you that it is right? OBJ 3

SINGLE CHOICE

- ○ Very confident
- ○ Fairly confident
- ○ Not very confident
- ○ Not at all confident
- ○ Don't know

SECTION D · IF A2 HAS AN ACTIVITY

Where the work goes

D1 Thinking about *[activity from B2]*, where do you usually finish that work? OBJ 1 OBJ 6

SINGLE CHOICE

- ○ In the IMSERV portal
- ○ In another reporting or analysis tool
- ○ Somewhere else (please say)
- ○ In a spreadsheet
- ○ In an email
- ○ Don't know

Logic. Pipes the answer to B2, or the only activity in A2.

D2 Which of these do you use for that work? OBJ 1

SELECT ALL THAT APPLY

- ☐ IMSERV portal
- ☐ Email
- ☐ Telephone
- ☐ Spreadsheet
- ☐ API or data feed
- ☐ Something else (please say)

D3 Who else is involved before that work is finished? OBJ 4

SELECT ALL THAT APPLY

- ☐ No one, I do it on my own
- ☐ Someone who approves it
- ☐ Someone outside my organisation
- ☐ Don't know
- ☐ Someone in my team
- ☐ Another team in my organisation
- ☐ IMSERV

Logic. "No one" and "Don't know" are exclusive → skip D4.

D4 In the past three months, how often did that work wait for someone else before it could carry on? OBJ 4 OBJ 6

SINGLE CHOICE

- ○ Every time
- ○ Sometimes
- ○ Don't know
- ○ Most times
- ○ Never

SECTION E · IF A2 HAS AN ACTIVITY

When things go wrong

E1 In the past three months, has a problem with IMSERV data or the service stopped you finishing a piece of work? OBJ 5 OBJ 6

SINGLE CHOICE

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No
- ◯ Don't know

Logic. No or Don't know → Section F.

E2 Thinking about the most recent time, what happened? OBJ 5

OPEN TEXT

Logic. Researchers code it later as interface, process, or data. Respondents are not asked to classify it.

E3 How was it resolved? OBJ 5

SINGLE CHOICE

- ◯ I sorted it myself
- ◯ Someone at IMSERV sorted it
- ◯ Someone in my organisation sorted it
- ◯ It is not resolved yet
- ◯ I gave up
- ◯ Don't know

E4 Has the same kind of problem happened before? OBJ 5 OBJ 6

SINGLE CHOICE

- ◯ Yes, more than once
- ◯ Yes, once
- ◯ No, this was the first time
- ◯ Don't know

SECTION F · EVERYONE WHO AGREED

About you and your organisation

F1 What kind of organisation do you work for? OBJ 2 OBJ 6

SINGLE CHOICE

- ◯ A customer of IMSERV
- ◯ A supplier
- ◯ Prefer not to say
- ◯ A broker or TPI
- ◯ Something else (please say)

F2 Which organisation do you work for? OBJ 6

SHORT TEXT, OPTIONAL

Logic. Used only to count organisations and report them apart from people. Never reported by name. Storage agreed with the privacy owner.

F3 About how many sites does your organisation have IMSERV meters on? OBJ 2

SINGLE CHOICE

- ◯ 1
- ◯ 11 to 100
- ◯ More than 1,000
- ◯ 2 to 10
- ◯ 101 to 1,000
- ◯ Don't know

Logic. Check band edges in the pilot.

F4 How long have you worked with IMSERV data? OBJ 2

SINGLE CHOICE

- ◯ Less than 6 months
- ◯ More than 2 years
- ◯ 6 months to 2 years
- ◯ Don't know

F5 Would you be happy to talk to us in a short follow-up conversation?

SINGLE CHOICE

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Logic. Yes → contact details on the next screen, stored apart from answers. Used to follow up where results and interviews disagree.

END SCREEN

"Thank you. Your answers help us design Astral around how people really work."

Questions to objectives

Every question serves an objective, apart from consent and the follow-up opt-in.

Objective	Research question	Questions that answer it
1. Understand	What triggers the work, and what does finished look like?	**A1**, **D1**, **D2**
2. Identify	Which patterns recur across organisations, roles, and scales?	**A2**, **B2**, **F1**, **F3**, **F4**
3. Understand	What do people check before relying on a figure?	**C1**, **C2**, **C3**
4. Identify	Who contributes, approves, or acts?	**D3**, **D4**
5. Determine	Where does it slow down, and why?	**E1**, **E2**, **E3**, **E4**
6. Gauge	How often do these happen?	**A1**, **A2**, **B1**, **C1**, **C2**, **D1**, **D4**, **E1**, **E4**, **F1**, **F2**

Pilot and analysis

Pilot with target users to check meaning, answer options, and effort. Set the response target only after we know the reachable population, sampling approach, and comparisons needed.

PILOT CHECKS

- Do people read each question the way we mean it?
- Do the answer options fit, including the grey placeholders once filled?
- Does each recall period fit the activity?
- How long does it take? Set the time on the introduction screen from this

ANALYSIS

- Results describe **respondents** unless the sampling supports wider claims
- Report people and customer organisations separately
- Open answers to E2 are coded as interface, process, or data
- More responses do not remove recruitment bias

Compared with the interviews

Research question	Interview	Walkthrough or artefact	Survey	Interpretation and next action
What makes a report trustworthy enough to share?	How people explain their checks and concerns	The actual checking steps and supporting material	Reported frequency across contexts	Supported needs, exceptions, and what is still uncertain
Where does issue resolution break down?	Accounts of ownership and waiting	Handoffs and correspondence	Reported occurrence and consequences	Separate interface problems from service-process problems

Each relationship is marked:

SUPPORTING COMPLEMENTARY CONFLICTING INSUFFICIENT

Neutral draft. No consent wording is sent until it is approved. Legal review before it reaches a participant.

Consent, privacy and data

Agreed with IMSERV's privacy and data-protection owner before the survey is sent. The same rules apply to survey answers.

Every session

- Informed consent for every participant before the session
- Recording, transcription, storage, retention, and any AI processing agreed with IMSERV's privacy and data-protection owner before the first session
- Approved storage with restricted access. Raw recordings and transcripts stay restricted
- Customer documents shown in walkthroughs are redacted or not kept, as agreed
- Participants are P01, P02 in analysis. Removing names alone may not anonymise a distinctive business account
- Quotes in shared outputs only with consent for anonymised quotation
- No consent wording is sent until it is approved. The current wording is a neutral draft

How AI is used

Copilot can help organise approved material, suggest candidate patterns, and keep evidence links up to date. Only within what the privacy owner approves.

It will **not** invent quotes, build archetypes from job titles, or treat simulated customers as evidence.

Risks and limits

What could weaken the evidence, and what we do about it.

Risk	Effect	Mitigation
The survey is open for only 8 working days	Fewer responses, mostly from engaged customers	Send it from a sender customers know. Send one reminder. Report respondents, not customers
The survey reaches only engaged customers	Patterns look more common than they are	Report respondents, not customers. Name the sampling limits
The survey runs before the interviews can shape it	It measures our assumptions, or uses words customers do not	Build answer options from scoping and existing notes. Pilot with target users. Keep a “Something else” answer and read it
Participants come from one or two organisations	Shared local process looks like a pattern	Track organisation coverage. Recruit across several
Recruitment or privacy approval is slow	The timeline moves	Agree both before week 1. Hold one or two reserve participants



Thank You

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